

Fundamentals of Communication

Topic-1

What is Communication?

- Communication is the process of exchanging information, ideas, thoughts, feelings, or instructions between people to create shared understanding.
- It is not simply the act of sending a message; communication is successful when the intended meaning is understood by the receiver.
- It may take place through spoken or written words, gestures, facial expressions, images, and digital media.

What is Communication?

- The word *communication* is derived from the Latin word *communicare*, meaning “to share,” “to make common,” or “to impart.”
- This meaning reflects the basic purpose of communication: to share information and ideas and establish a common understanding between people.
- **Example:** When a teacher explains an assignment and students understand what they are expected to do, effective communication has taken place.

Definitions by Scholars

- According to **W.H. Newman and C.F. Summer**: **"Communication is an exchange of facts, ideas, opinions or emotions by two or more persons."**
- According to **Keith Davis**: **"Communication is the process of passing information and understanding from one person to another."**
- These definitions emphasize that communication is not merely the transfer of information but also the development of mutual understanding.

Why People Communicate

- **To inform:** Sharing facts, information, or knowledge.
Example: A teacher informing students about an examination date.
- **To instruct:** Giving directions or explaining how something should be done.
Example: A supervisor explaining a laboratory procedure.
- **To express:** Communicating feelings, opinions, attitudes, or personal experiences.
Example: A student expressing concern about an academic problem.

Why People Communicate

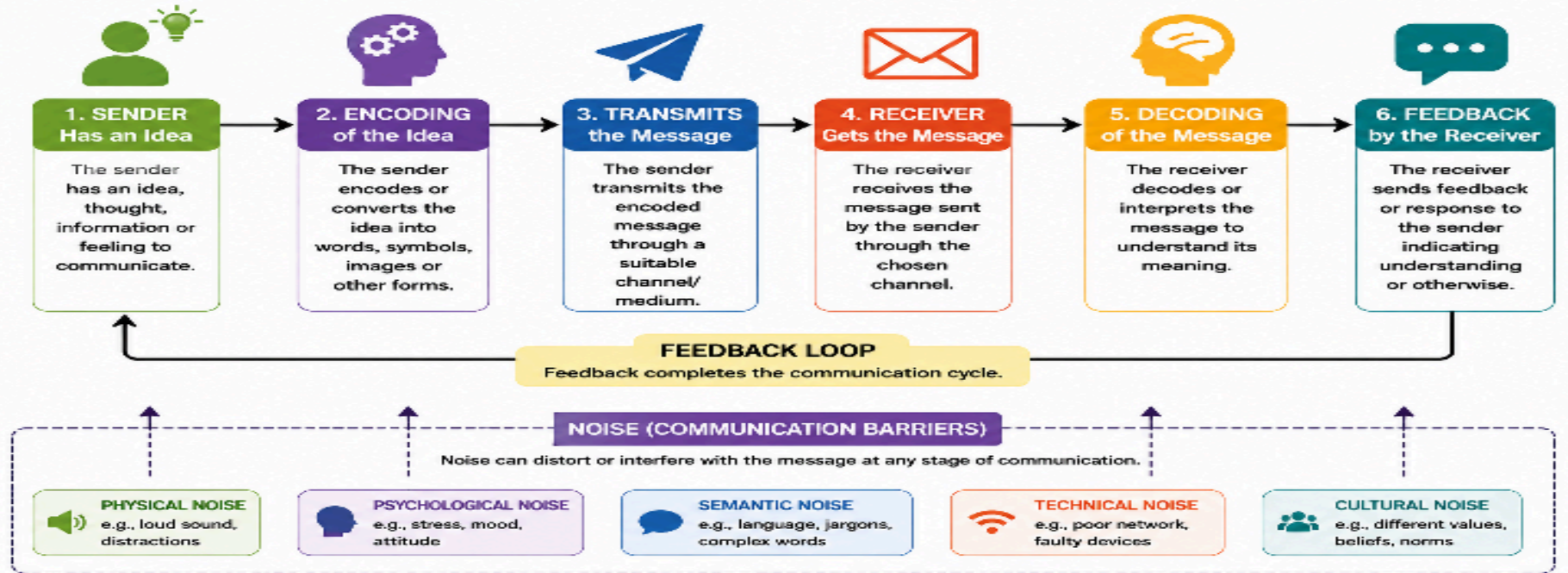
- **To persuade:** Influencing someone's ideas, decisions, or actions.
Example: A student persuading classmates to participate in a social campaign.
- **To build relationships:** Establishing and maintaining personal or professional connections.
Example A student introducing themselves to a researcher at a conference.
- **To coordinate:** Helping people work together towards a common objective.
Example: Team members discussing their responsibilities for a project.

Process of Communication

- Communication is a systematic process through which information, ideas, thoughts, or feelings are exchanged between a sender and a receiver to achieve mutual understanding.
- It involves a series of steps that ensure the message is communicated accurately and effectively.

Process of Communication

PROCESS OF COMMUNICATION



1. Sender Has an Idea

- The sender is the **person who initiates communication** because they have an idea, information, feeling, or instruction to convey.
- The sender decides what needs to be communicated and to whom.
- The effectiveness of communication begins with the sender's understanding of the purpose and audience.
- A clear purpose helps the sender choose appropriate words and a suitable channel.
- **Example:** A teacher realizes that the assignment deadline needs to be changed and decides to inform the students.

2. Sender Encodes the Idea

- Encoding is the process of **converting an idea into a form that can be communicated.**
- This may involve selecting words, symbols, images, gestures, or tone according to the situation.
- Effective encoding requires the sender to consider the receiver's knowledge and level of understanding.
- Poorly chosen words or unclear expressions can lead to misunderstanding.
- **Example:** The teacher writes, “The assignment submission deadline is extended to Friday, 8 August,2026.”

3. Sender Transmits the Message

- The channel is the **medium used to transmit the message** from the sender to the receiver.
- Common channels include face-to-face conversation, telephone, email, messaging applications, presentations, and video meetings.
- The choice of channel should depend on the urgency, complexity, formality, and nature of the message.
- **Example:** The teacher uses email to communicate the revised assignment deadline to the entire class.

4. Receiver Receives the Message

- The receiver is the **person or group for whom the message is intended**.
- The receiver receives the message through the selected channel and attempts to understand its meaning.
- Their knowledge, attention, expectations, and previous experience can influence how they interpret the message.
- Communication is successful only when the receiver understands the intended meaning.
- **Example:** The students receive the teacher's email and read the updated deadline.

5. Receiver Decodes the Message

- Decoding is the process through which the receiver interprets and gives meaning to the message.
- The receiver uses their language knowledge, experience, and understanding of the context to interpret what the sender means.
- If the message is unclear or unfamiliar, the receiver may misunderstand it.
- Example: A student reads the message and understands that the new submission deadline is Friday, 8 August, 2026.

6. Receiver Gives Feedback

- Feedback is the **receiver's response to the message**, which indicates whether the message has been understood or whether further clarification is needed.
- It may be verbal, written, or non-verbal.
- Feedback makes communication interactive rather than a one-way process.
- It also allows the sender to correct misunderstandings.
- **Example:** A student replies, “**Could you please confirm whether the assignment should be submitted online?**” The question provides feedback and requests clarification.

Noise (Communication Barriers)

- **Noise** refers to any interference or obstacle that disrupts the communication process, causing the message to be misunderstood, distorted, or not received as intended.
- It can occur at any stage of communication, from the sender to the receiver.
- **Key Point:** Noise is not a step in the communication process.
- It is an external factor that can interfere with communication at any stage, reducing clarity, accuracy, and effectiveness.

Conclusion

- Communication is a fundamental process of exchanging information, ideas, feelings, and intentions to create shared understanding.
- It involves several connected stages, beginning with the sender's idea and continuing through encoding, message transmission, reception, decoding, and feedback.
- Each stage plays an important role in ensuring that the intended message is understood correctly.

Conclusion

- Since communication involves a continuous exchange between participants, it is interactive and circular rather than simply one-way.
- Understanding these fundamentals helps individuals communicate more clearly, purposefully, and effectively in academic, professional, and everyday situations.

THANK YOU